

Unit 01

- A thread is the smallest unit of execution inside a process.

chrome: one thread load the page

Another play video

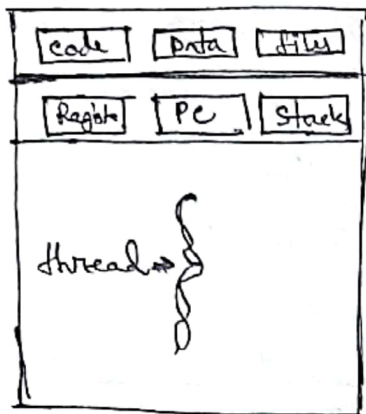
Another handles user input

Basic component of thread:

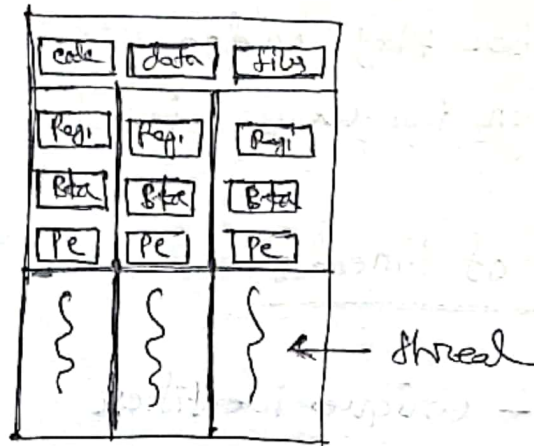
1. Thread ID - unique identifier
2. Program counter: next instruction counter
3. Registers: store intermediate values
4. Stack: function calls, local variables

Process	Thread
Separate memory	Shared memory
communication slow	Fast
creation slow	Fast
crash impact one process crash $\neq$ others	one thread crash may affect whole process
High Resource usage	low Resource usage

Thread is a unit of execution. It has following attributes:

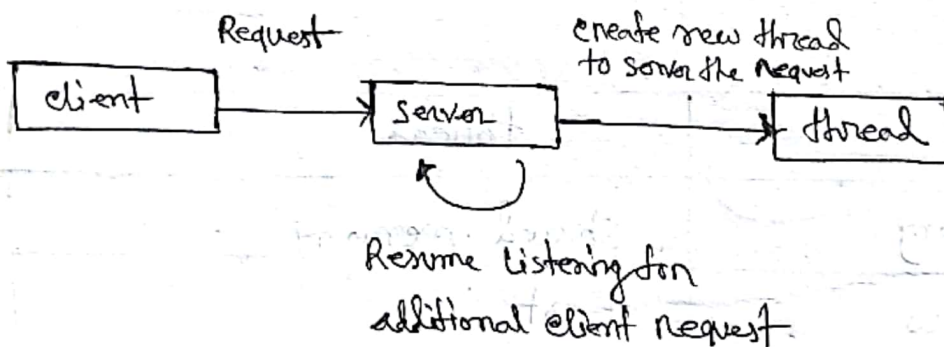


Single thread



Multithread Process

Multithread Server Architecture:



Benefits:

- Responsiveness: Application remains responsive even if a thread is busy
- Resource Sharing: Thread share the same memory and Resources
- Economy (low cost): Creating threads is cheaper than processes.
- Scalability: can run multiple thread on multiple

- Improve performance: Tasks can run concurrently.

Challenges:

- synchronization problem: multiple thread accessing shared data can cause error.
- Race condition: output depend on thread execution order.
- Deadlock: Thread wait forever for each other.
- Starvation: some threads never get CPU time.
- complex debugging: Hard to find bugs.
- context switching overhead: Switching between threads cost CPU time.

• multicore / multiprocessor system challenges:

Dividing activities

Balance

Data splitting

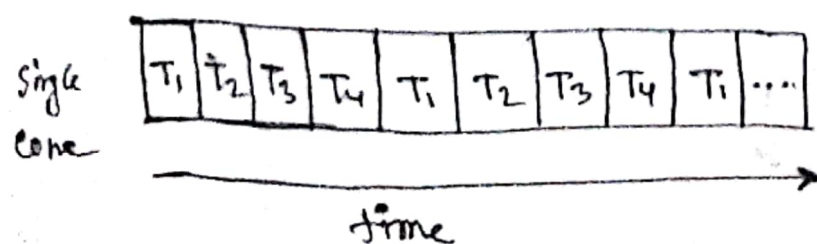
Data dependency

Testing and debugging

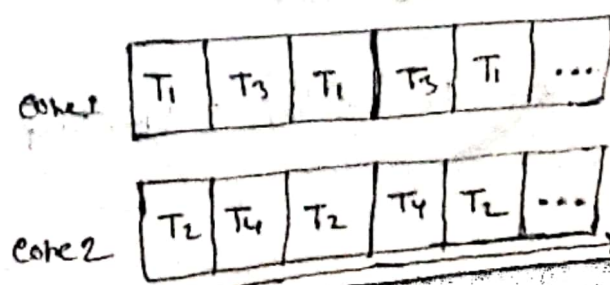
Parallelism: implies a system can perform more than one task simultaneously.

Concurrency support more than one task making progress, single core

• concurrent execution on single core



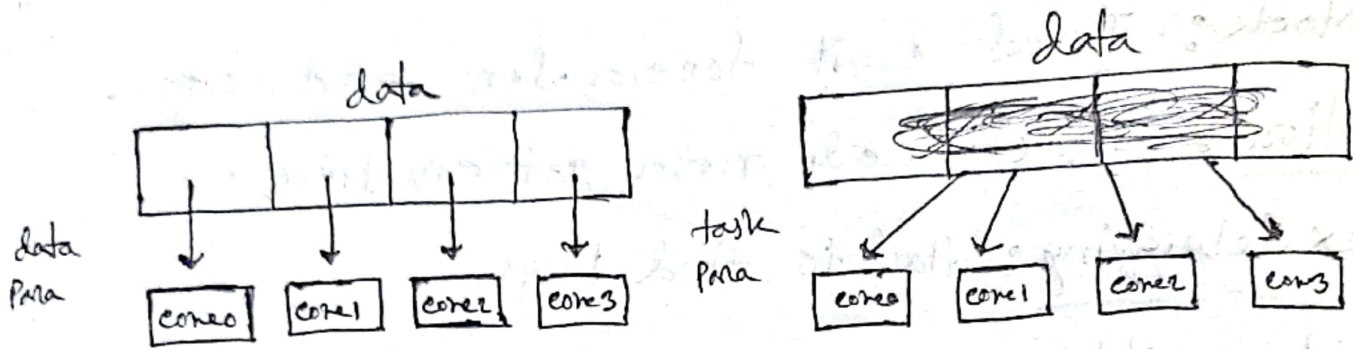
• Parallelism on a multicore system



Parallelism type:

Data Parallelism: distributes subsets of the same data across cores. Same operation on each

Task Parallelism: distributing threads across cores, each thread perform unique operation.



Amdahl's Law: is used to measure the maximum improvement in performance when part of a system is made faster.

$$\text{Speedup} = \frac{1}{(1-P) + \frac{P}{N}}$$

P = Portion of the Program that be Parallelized

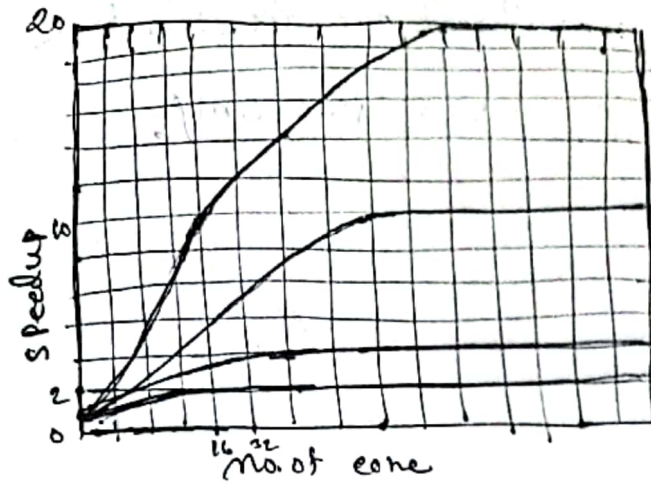
$(1-P)$ = Portion that must remain sequential

N = no. of thread, core

Ex. Parallel, 20% serial, core, 2

Speed up 6 time

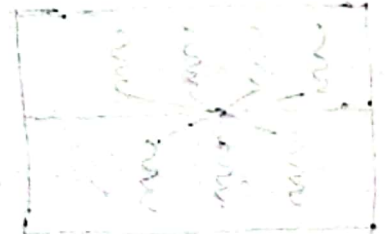
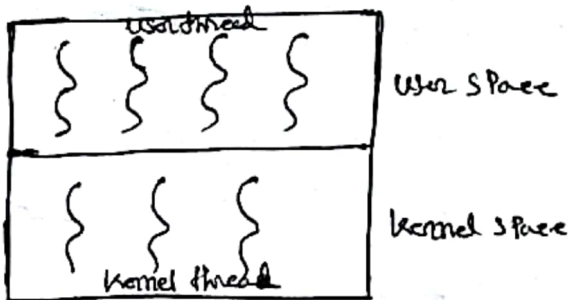
When N infinity : Speedup $\frac{1}{P}$



- user thread are managed by a user level thread library, not by the OS kernel.

Three type: POSIX thread (Pthread)
Windows thread
Java thread

- kernel thread are managed by the OS kernel.
Linux, Windows, macOS, iOS, Android.

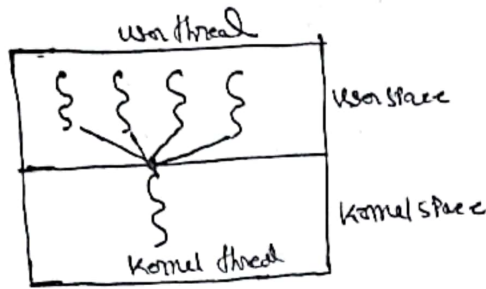


Multi threading model: define how user thread are mapped to kernel thread.

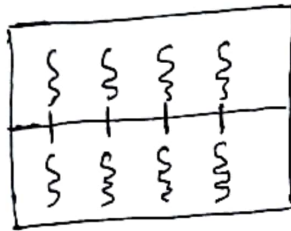
Three type:



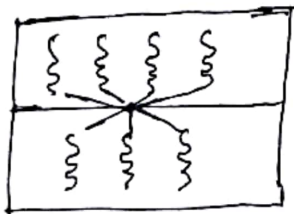
many to one model: All user threads are mapped to a single kernel thread manage in user space only.



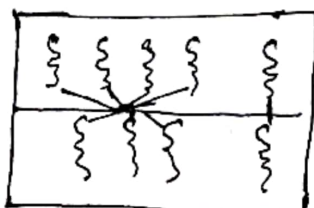
one to one model: Each user thread has its own kernel OS schedule each thread independently.



many to many model: multiple user threads are mapped to multiple kernel threads OS can schedule them freely.



two level ~~three~~ model: many to many ~~are~~ except that it allows a user thread to be bound to kernel thread.



Thread library provide Programmer with API for creating and managing thread.

Two Primary way:

- Library entirely in user space
- kernel level library supported by the OS

Pthread:

Java thread: are managed by the JVM.

Implicit Threading: Five method:

Thread Pools

Fork Join

OpenMP

Grand central Dispatch

Intel Threading Building Blocks.

implicit threading means the programmer does not manually create/ manage threads instead the system (compiler, OS) handles it automatically.

A Thread Pool is a collection of pre-created threads that wait for task.

How work:

Thread are created once and store in Pools.

Task are submitted to a queue.

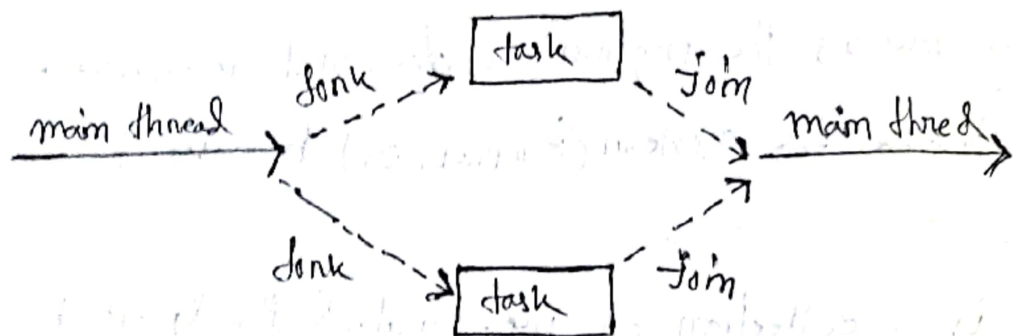
Available thread. Picks a task and execute it.

- Adv
- Reduce overhead of creating/destroying threads
 - Better Performance
 - Limited no. of concurrent threads

dis Fixed Pool size may cause waiting

Task-join - multiple thread (tasks) are forked, and then join

- How work:
- main task divided into subtask
 - subtask run in parallel
 - Result are combined.



- Adv
- efficient so a divide and conquer problem
 - Automatic Parallelism

Grand signal dispatch: A high level API that manages thread execution automatically using Dispatch queue.

Working:

Developer submit task to queue

System decides:

When to run & decides whether to use which thread to use.

Adv : ∴ very simple to use

Optimize by OS

No manual thread handling.

dis less control over threads.

~~OpenMP~~

OpenMP is an API for shared memory parallel programming using compiler directives. Used in C, C++

How work: add special program and the compiler automatically create thread.

- Intel Threading Building Block is a C++ template library for task based parallelism.

works: define task

TBB runtime schedules them across available

Signal handling is a mechanism used by the OS to notify process that event has occurred.

Signal handler is used to process signal.

1. Signal is generated by particular event.
2. Signal is delivered to a process.
3. Signal is handled by one or two signal handlers.
default, user defined.

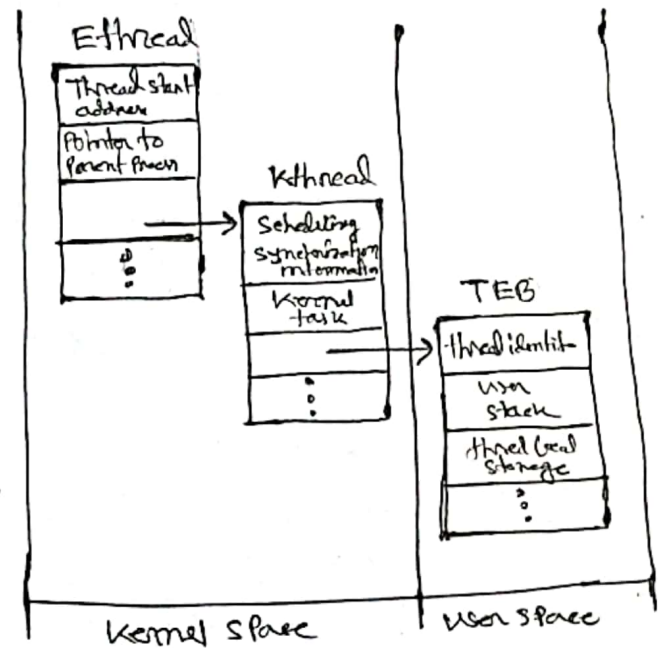
Windows Thread Representation:

In Microsoft Windows, threads are treated as separate kernel objects.

Each thread has:

Thread ID
Register set
Stack
Thread environment

- Thread shares process resource but execute independently.
- Uses one-to-one threading model.



Linux Thread: Threads are implemented as Lightweight Processes.

Represent using task struct

create using clone() system call

Thread share resource: memory

flag	meaning